

ALEXANDER MERCER

Senior Cybersecurity & Red Team Specialist

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Professional Summary

Dedicated and results-driven Cybersecurity Expert with over 7 years of experience in offensive security, penetration testing, threat modeling, and security architecture design. Specialized in identifying high-impact vulnerabilities across enterprise cloud infrastructures, Web applications, and internal networks. Proven track record of leading Red Team engagements, automating vulnerability workflows, and collaborating with cross-functional development teams to build secure-by-design systems.

Core Competencies & Technical Skills

Category	Technical Skills & Frameworks
Offensive Security	Penetration Testing, Red Teaming, Vulnerability Assessment, IDOR, Privilege Escalation, Exploitation Development, Wireless & Network Auditing
Tools & Platforms	Burp Suite Professional, Metasploit, Nmap, Wireshark, Scapy, Aircrack-ng, Cobalt Strike, Nessus, SQLmap
Security Automation	Python Scripting, Bash, PowerShell, CI/CD Pipeline Security Integration, Custom Exploit Scripts
Cloud & Infrastructure	AWS Security, Docker/Kubernetes Auditing, Linux/Unix Administration, Active Directory Security, Network Segmentation
Frameworks & Standards	MITRE ATT&CK, OWASP Top 10, NIST SP 800-53, ISO/IEC 27001, PTES

Professional Experience

Senior Penetration Tester & Red Team Lead	<i>Apex Cyber Solutions 2023 – Present</i>
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- Lead full-scope Red Team operations simulating advanced persistent threats (APTs) for Fortune 500 financial clients, uncovering 45+ critical infrastructure flaws.
- Developed automated Python-based scanning modules that reduced manual reconnaissance time by 40% across multi-tenant cloud environments.
- Conducted complex web application, API, and mobile penetration tests adhering to OWASP standards.
- Presented detailed technical risk reports and remediation plans directly to executive stakeholders (CISO, CTO).

Cybersecurity Engineer / Analyst	<i>Vanguard Defense Tech 2020 – 2023</i>
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- Executed network infrastructure security audits, wireless penetration tests, and vulnerability assessments for enterprise networks.
- Implemented DevSecOps practices into existing CI/CD pipelines using automated static and dynamic analysis tools (SAST/DAST).
- Analyzed threat vectors, engineered custom intrusion prevention rules, and supported incident response teams during active breach triage.
- Mentored junior security analysts on offensive security tactics, root cause analysis, and secure code review principles.

Professional Certifications

- **Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP)** – OffSec
- **Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)** – (ISC)²
- **Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)** – EC-Council
- **AWS Certified Security – Specialty** – Amazon Web Services

Education & Achievements

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science & Cybersecurity	<i>2016 – 2020</i>
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State University of Technology – Graduated with Honors (GPA: 3.8/4.0)

Notable Achievements & Projects

- **Bug Bounty Recognition:** Top 1% researcher on major bug bounty platforms; reported critical vulnerabilities (IDOR, RCE) to global enterprises.
- **Open Source Tool Development:** Authored a lightweight reconnaissance wrapper published on GitHub with over 1,200 stars.